

visibility and management capabilities of VMware vSphere,” said Ray O’Farrell, executive vice president and chief technology officer, VMware, in a statement.

Admiral provides enterprises a built-in container management portal right through vSphere Integrated Containers. When joined together with VMware vRealize Automation and vSphere Integrated Containers, the software project delivers Containers-as-a-Service (CaaS) to application development teams. Developers can use the combination to model different containerised applications.

Harbor, on the other hand, empowers VMware to offer various enterprise features such as user management and access control, policy-based image replication, audit and log support and a RESTful API for integration. All this comes through a Docker distribution, which is powering the open source software at the backend.

Developers and entrepreneurs who want to test the new features through VMware vSphere Integrated Containers can register for its beta programme. A GitHub repository is also available to provide the code of Admiral and Harbor projects.

Facebook open sources its data compression and storage technologies

Facebook has open sourced a collection of compression and storage tools. The social networking giant wants to empower enterprises to scale their existing platforms to reach a larger user base while minimising their storage needs.

The company has released its Zstandard compression algorithm that offers a lossless compression technology, replacing the existing libraries powered by the outdated Deflate algorithm. Facebook claims that its new offering is much faster and more efficient than standard compression models. The Zstandard compression algorithm is supposedly five times faster than Deflate and files are 10 per cent smaller. The core algorithm inside the popular compression formats (Zip, gzip and zlib) is the Deflate compression model. Deflate as well as other algorithms have offered either



good compression quality or fast compression speed, but never both. However, Facebook is set to face the real challenge by introducing the new standard.

Apart from Zstandard, Facebook has open sourced MyRocks — the next generation MySQL storage engine. According to the company, MyRocks can save 50 per cent of storage space when compared to compressed InnoDB. Likewise, MyRocks-powered RocksDB has several advantages over the default InnoDB storage. RocksDB uses a minimal number of overall I/O per read or update. The database is comparatively lightweight, and puts a negligible strain on the write endurance of Flash storage. You can use MyRocks only via a fork of MySQL 5.6.

The best part is that both Zstandard and MyRocks have been tested at scale within Facebook for over six months. Facebook has noted impressive results with both the technologies. Moreover, the Mark Zuckerberg-led team believes that these technologies will be adopted more quickly as an open source solution than as a proprietary package of a single company.

Late last month, Facebook released the code of its three artificial intelligence (AI) tools that are an upgrade on the current state of machine vision technology.

SUSE becomes HPE's preferred Linux partner

HP Enterprise (HPE) has expanded its long-term alliance with SUSE by announcing the open source company as its preferred Linux partner. This announcement has emerged in the course of the merger of SUSE parent Micro Focus with HPE's Software Business Segment.

“Our alliance with HPE is another example of SUSE's strategy to partner openly and broadly to provide increased choice in the marketplace for enterprise software-defined infrastructure solutions,” said Nils Brauckmann, CEO of SUSE, in a statement.



The Berkshire (UK) based Micro Focus announced the merger with HPE's software business in a US\$ 8.8 billion deal. By making this move, both firms aim to manage both growing and mature software assets of the US company, which has already planned its future with major IT offerings.

Micro Focus and HPE are exploring collaboration to leverage SUSE's OpenStack expertise for joint innovation around HPE's Helion OpenStack and the Stackato Platform-as-a-Service.

SUSE and HPE are set to specify the terms of their commercial partnership, aiming to complete the deal in the fourth quarter of 2016. The partnership will ultimately give a boost to the software company that has been providing the world's second largest Linux platform in the form of SUSE.